

10 things to say when you disagree

Winning people over and winning arguments are two very different things. If your goal is to persuade someone, it's usually best to steer clear of negative, adversarial comments. The next time you're tempted to say something that might feel good in the moment but could alienate the other person, try one of our alternatives instead.

Instead of ...	Try ...
"You're wrong."	"Could you help me understand why you think that?"
"That will never work."	"What if instead we ... ?"
"I disagree."	"I think we both want the same outcome. I have another solution to propose."
"How could you think that?"	"Could you explain more what you mean?"
"You're the only one who thinks that."	"I haven't heard much from others about that. Tell me more."
"That's not true."	"What makes you say that?"
"Just do it."	"This would really help, because ... "
"OK, but ... "	"That makes sense, and also ... "
"But management said we had to do it."	"It will benefit the team to try this."
"What about me?"	"What would be better for you?"